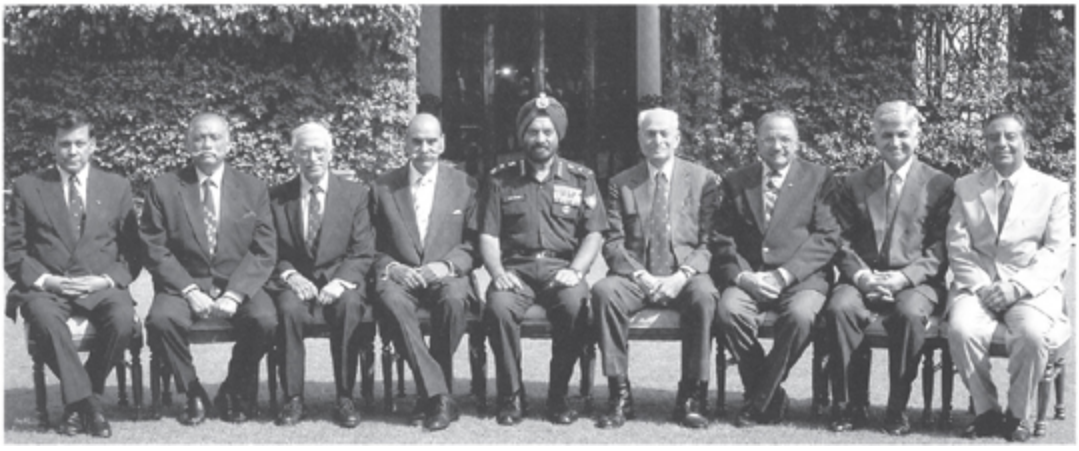
provided the ideal opportunity to uncork some fine champagne in honour of the first guests to our new home.

That was the day, as they say, on which I hung up my spurs. I no longer was the 'Jangi Laat'. Except for the two of us, it would be life as usual the next day for everyone present that evening – just another working day. *C'est la vie!*

I have tried to project in this story the soldier that I was and my performance in the assignments that were given to me, and I stepped out of uniform with grace, dignity and with my chin up. The rest is for the people to judge.

And when you have reached the mountain top, then you shall begin to climb.

– Kahlil Gibran



All the 'chiefs' at the Conclave–2006 at Army House: (From left to right) Generals S. Padmanabhan, S. Roychowdhury, V.N. Sharma, O.P. Malhotra, the author, K.V. Krishna Rao, S.F. Rodrigues, V.P. Malik and N.C. Vij.